Cupboard Leaves

From the madrasa of Sultan Hassan

Bahri Mamluk, 757-64 AH / 1356-63 CE

2801 - W: 31 cm; H: 235 cm 4155 - W: 30.3 cm; H: 235 cm

Inv. no. 2801, 4155



This pair of narrow cabinet leaves was originally hung on pivots, as evidenced by the rounded and moulded upper terminals of the door stiles and the surviving metal pivot at the base; their slender proportions suggesting an interior cupboard rather than an exterior door. The leaves are constructed using interlocking joinery in the pattern known locally as kirindazi, wherein alternating elongated hexagons and triangles form the structural and decorative framework. The carving is largely uniform: hexagonal panels bear intersecting symmetrical arabesques, while triangular panels contain small

bifurcated leaves within a simple scroll. The two panels at handle-height, positioned directly above where the original fittings would have been affixed, show the heaviest wear; that on the left departs entirely from the prevailing decorative scheme, its abraded surface revealing large scrolls terminating in trilobed fleurons, hinting at a more complex decorative history than the otherwise consistent surface treatment would suggest.

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